

A place in society

Inside view

Conversation 1

- Andy** I love Chinese, but is the food around here typical?
- Janet** Well, it depends (on) what you mean by typical. This is mostly Cantonese food, from the south, except for the roast duck, which is from Beijing. But it's different from the food where I come from, in the northeast.
- Andy** And which is better?
- Janet** Er, well, in my opinion, I think ... Oh, look, here he comes. Hi Tony!
- Tony** Hey, Li Hui. *Ni hao*.
- Janet** *Ni hao*! Tony, this is Andy, my colleague.
- Tony** Hi.
- Janet** We were wondering if we could ask you some questions about life in Chinatown.
- Andy** I don't know if Janet's told you, but we're doing a series of reviews on the ethnic restaurants here in London for London Time Off.
- Tony** OK, I see.
- Andy** And the thing is, everyone eats Chinese and Indian food, but we want to put a bit of background and history on the website. Are you up for this?
- Tony** OK, fire away!
- Andy** What I suggest is, if you've got time, we'll do some filming around here, and then we'll put the research together back at the studio.

... Janet, are you ready with the sound this time?

- Janet** OK.
- Andy** Just remember to keep the needle out of the red zone. And don't forget to stop us if there's too much background noise.
- Janet** OK, thanks.
- Andy** Tony, you work here in Chinatown. Do you live here as well?
- Tony** No, in fact, very few Chinese actually live in Chinatown.
- Andy** And in comparison with Chinatown in, say, San Francisco or Sydney, is it larger or smaller?
- Tony** I'd say it's much smaller. Really, it's only three or four streets.
- Andy** And the business here, is it mostly the restaurant trade?
- Tony** Yes, as well as the supermarkets which stock produce from China.

Conversation 2

- Andy** So where do you call home?
- Tony** Well, like lots of people, my grandparents came from Hong Kong in the 1950s. But I'm a British-born Chinese so I guess this is home now.
- Andy** So how long has there been a Chinese community in London?
- Tony** For 200 years. When the Chinese first came to London, they arrived as sailors so they lived in the East End, by the Docks.
- Andy** And how did they make their living?

- Tony** Restaurants mostly, but they were also famous for running laundries.
- Andy** And why did Chinatown move over here?
- Tony** At the start of the 20th century some of them moved to the West End, which is the entertainment district, to open Chinese restaurants. And gradually, the Chinese from all over London met friends and did business here.
- Andy** And does it still feel like a traditional Chinese community?
- Tony** Oh sure. You saw the Chinese gateway and we celebrate Chinese New Year along with the Chinese all over the world.
- Andy** Thanks.
- Tony** You're welcome.
- Andy** How's it going, Janet?
- Janet** It's fine, that's about three minutes of material.
- Andy** OK. Let's wind it up, then. Tony, thank you very much, that was really interesting. Very grateful.
- Tony** No problem. Now, are you hungry? How about some dimsum and crispy roast duck?
- Janet** Sounds great! I'm starving. Thanks!
- Tony** Don't mention it. Let's go back to my restaurant.
- Andy** Sure, I'm starving too! All this talk about food! Thanks, Tony.
- Tony** You're welcome.

In some situations, we're used to it. We even expect it. When you're on a crowded street, or trying to get into a crowded bus, other people are going to start shoving. It's not always pleasant, but it's not surprising when it happens. But what about here, on this lovely beach? There's plenty of room for everyone to sit comfortably, enjoy the sun, and look at the ocean. Let's say you're sitting on the beach, it's not too crowded, and someone comes up and puts their stuff right in front of you. What would you do?

- Speaker 1** I'd be very angry and go over to them and tell them to move.
- Speaker 2** Maybe throw a little sand in their face and make them move, I don't know.
- Speaker 3** If someone came and sat down right in front of me on the beach, I would probably move my towel next to them and start a conversation.
- Presenter** Now let's take Jack out to the street. This is South Beach in Miami. Getting a parking place in this neighbourhood can be really difficult. That's because there are too many cars and not enough space. And when space is limited, people can get a lot more aggressive. Our producer is parked here in this very desirable parking spot. She's going to wait until someone wants her parking space. There's a lot of traffic, so she won't have to wait too long. Yes! There's someone now.

Outside view

Part 1

- Presenter** We're taking a walk along this peaceful, quiet beach. Just the place to relax. But out there, at other beaches around the world, that's another story. Let's take a look. These sea lions fight to defend their territory. During the mating season, these elephant seals show aggression to establish dominance. People fight to defend their territory.

Part 2

- Driver** Leaving?
- Producer** Yeah, I'm leaving.
- Driver** Oh, great!
- Presenter** She pulls out, and the minute she pulls out, Jack pulls in. What do you think the driver will do? Drive away? Or stop and confront Jack?
- Driver** Hey! Hey! Come on, pal! That's my spot, my parking spot!
- Jack** Oh yeah? I didn't see you in it. Well,

- looks like it's my space now! Sorry!
- Driver** What are you talking about, man? You saw me, I was right there!
- Jack** You know, have you considered anger management counselling?
- Driver** I was right there! What are you talking about?
- Jack** Ah, it's now time for the sunny tunes of "South Florida".
- Driver** I was right there. You saw me!
- Jack** What? I'm sorry, I can't hear what you're saying.
- Driver** You saw me, come on!
- Jack** Great song, isn't it? I love this song.
- Driver** Do you like it when people do that crap to you?
- Jack** Do you have a hearing problem? You scream a lot.
- Driver** No! You have ... problem!
- Jack** Yeah. Whew!
- Presenter** If you're waiting to pull into a parking space and someone else sneaks right into it, what would you do?
- Speaker 4** I would beep my horn, I would roll, roll down the window, and I would shout very rude things at them.
- Speaker 5** I would yell out the window and tell them to move!
- Presenter** Aggression. It's part of survival. Animals and humans need to be aggressive in order to survive. But how aggressive do we need to be? When do we fight? When do we give up and walk away? Those are the decisions that we all make every day.

Listening in

News report

The residents of Flint, Michigan are facing a water crisis. The city's water supply contains toxic levels of lead, and residents have been warned not to drink the water that comes through their taps.

The city's lead water pipes must be replaced to improve the quality of drinking water. However, many people in the city had been drinking the water before they were told it was dangerous. Lead poisoning can produce lifelong health effects, and children who are exposed to lead even at low levels are at risk of brain damage, behavioural problems and learning disabilities.

The city of Flint, which is populated by low-income people of colour, has finally started to get the help it has needed for years. Many local and national organizations are providing residents with free bottled water. The Flint Water Fund is collecting money to help pay for filters and bottled water. Many people across the country are also making donations, and volunteering their time to help distribute clean water to residents. Flint residents are grateful to the volunteers for the support they have been given during this difficult time.

- 1 What problem do the residents of Flint, Michigan have?
- 2 How are volunteers helping residents?

Passage 1

Part 1

Today we'll focus on two aspects of group behavior. Firstly, how groups develop, and secondly, the roles individuals play within a group. It's widely acknowledged that the performance of effective groups is often greater than the sum of the individuals in the group. This is due to what we call synergy – in other words, the extra energy and effectiveness that people create when they work together.

Early research in this field carried out in the 1930s by Elton Mayo discovered something that he called the "Hawthorne effect". The idea is that when individuals know they are part of a study, their productivity automatically increases regardless of other factors, such as how much time or money they are given, for example. The research suggests that things like personal identity, self-esteem and the social context in which a group is working are really very important factors in improving the performance of individuals.

If we move on to look at the nature of groups more closely, we find that groups have

natural phases that can help us understand their effectiveness. You have probably all had experience of working with other people in a group that, at first, wasn't very productive. This phenomenon was studied by Tuckman in the 1960s, and he created a model to describe the stages of a group.

The first stage is known as "Forming" which is when individual members get to know each other. This is followed by "Storming" when individuals start to share their ideas and creative energy. The third phase is "Norming" where a group identity begins to form. The final stage is "Performing" when individuals within the group work together. And it is at this stage that the group achieves results. Understanding these phases can help us ensure that members of a group work together to overcome early problems and begin performing as quickly as possible.

Part 2

Next I will look at the roles of individuals within groups. A group that is made up of individuals who have similar personalities may not work effectively. In the 1980s Belbin identified eight different roles that can help build effective teams. The "Chairperson" is someone who is self-confident and encourages others to contribute.

Then there is the "Company worker" – he or she is conservative and helps organize others.

The "Shaper" is outgoing and dynamic and motivates others – whereas the "Plant" is a genius who is often a loner.

The "Resource investigator" is the group member who is always curious and explores new ideas and the "Monitor-evaluator" is calm and serious and makes good, balanced decisions.

The "Teamworker" in contrast is a socially orientated and sensitive member of the team who is able to encourage a team spirit. And the "Completer-finisher" is a conscientious perfectionist who follows through on the details and ties up any loose ends. To be effective, a team needs to have a variety of members who can fulfil all these different roles.

Passage 2

Today I'm reporting from Phuket in southern Thailand. Parts of the island were devastated by the

tsunami in 2004, and over 250 people lost their lives here. I've come back to see how one community has recovered.

Here in the village of Tha Chat Chai, the rebuilding of the destroyed homes has been led by the international organization Habitat for Humanity. About a year after the tsunami occurred, volunteers began building 36 new homes for local families.

One villager, Somwang, is certainly very happy with the results. He used to live in a small hut on his two-square-metre plot of land near the sea. The local community wanted him to have a bigger home and despite the small size of his plot of land, they built him a three-storey house, which is now the tallest in the village. A happy ending to such a horrific tragedy.

The rebuilding here has also had a positive effect on the local economy, because the earth bricks that were used to build the homes were produced in Khao Lak, another tsunami hit island – all part of a post-tsunami livelihood development project.

Talking to people here, I've discovered that the project not only provided them with much needed shelter, but also the process has helped rebuild a spirit of community amongst them. A host of foreign as well as local volunteers joined together to work in rebuilding the villagers' homes and lives, and even an American TV celebrity volunteered.

The project has also been visited by former US president Jimmy Carter, who is an active supporter of Habitat for Humanity. He and his wife offer one week of their time every year to volunteer on construction projects around the world.

It's certainly encouraging to see the strength of the human spirit and generosity of people who help others in times of need.

Habitat for Humanity is continuing their work in the south of Thailand, helping poor local families and communities to improve their lives. Their "Save and Build" scheme encourages families to save 30 per cent of the cost of building or rebuilding their home. The charity then lends the family the rest of the money they need, and helps in the building of their new home. It's then paid for in monthly repayments of under \$30, which supports those who want to build a better life for themselves. This is Marianne Harper reporting from southern Thailand ...

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High days and holidays

Inside view

Conversation 1

- Janet* So do you come here often, Joe?
- Joe* Yes, most weekends. It's the kind of thing a lot of Londoners do when they've got some time off.
- Janet* So do you feel like a Londoner, Joe?
- Joe* Yes, I think so. You don't have to be born a Londoner to feel like one.
- Janet* Is it only open on Saturday?
- Andy* It's open all week, but there are a lot more stalls open from Friday to Sunday.
- Janet* What time does it open?
- Joe* It's open between 10 am and 6 pm.
- Janet* 6 o'clock. That's quite early!
- Joe* Well, after six, everyone goes out to the pubs and restaurants and the clubs. So it gets pretty lively in the evening. It's a very trendy kind of place.
- Janet* And it's got clothes and jewellery and ...
- Andy* They sell pretty well everything here.
- Janet* It's very colourful. Is it a special occasion?
- Joe* No, just an ordinary weekend. But it's true that on holiday weekends, it gets very busy.
- Andy* And all around here there are movie houses and clubs, and all sorts of cool places to hang out. That's the Electric Ballroom down there ...
- Janet* What's that?

- Andy* It's one of THE great clubs in London, all sorts of bands have played there.
- Janet* I've never been to a club. It must be fun.
- Andy* OK, are you busy tonight?
- Janet* Er, why do you ask?
- Andy* Maybe we could go there? Have you any plans?
- Janet* I'd love to, but I'm afraid I ...
- Andy* OK, no problem. Maybe some other time.

Conversation 2

- Janet* People always seem to be having fun in London! Camden Market was great!
- Joe* Great for shopping!
- Andy* Well, there are lots and lots of festivals of film and music. And there are also quite a few street festivals, like the Notting Hill Carnival.
- Janet* OK, and what happens?
- Andy* I'll show you some footage from last year.
- Andy* Notting Hill is a district of London, and it has a large West Indian community. So at Carnival, the kids and adults go on a parade through the streets, wearing these amazing costumes and dancing to live Caribbean music.
- Joe* And there's lots of street food, and music and parties going on along the carnival route. Yes, it is great fun.
- Janet* And does everyone in London go to watch?
- Joe* Well, it attracts about two million people a year.

Janet Wow! And when does it happen?
Andy It takes place at the end of August, although the usual time for carnival for the rest of the world is February.
Janet What does "carnival" mean?
Joe It's a festival which takes place in many Catholic countries 40 days before Easter, after which everyone is meant to eat and drink only moderately. And the carnival in Rio de Janeiro in Brazil is probably the best-known, but there are also carnivals in other cities.
Janet But then why is the Notting Hill Carnival in August?
Joe Because for the rest of the year, the weather is awful. Anyway, we'd better be going now, Janet.
Janet Oh, yes.
Andy Go where?
Joe I invited Janet to a jazz concert this evening. It starts in half an hour.
Janet Bye Andy. Take care!
Andy Bye Janet. Look after yourself.

February-Marchish. That's probably one of my favourite Vietnamese holidays.

Presenter Asians usually celebrate this holiday by letting off firecrackers to send out the old year and to welcome the new year. They usually don't wash their hair on New Year's. Washing hair washes away good luck for the coming year. This woman used to live in Shanghai, China. She remembers a tradition that brings good luck and wealth to children.

Chinese One special custom for Chinese New Year is that parents give their children red envelopes of money.

Presenter Red is an important colour because it means happiness. People use red paper to write special messages of happiness like this one. "May the Star of Happiness, the Star of Wealth, and the Star of Longevity shine on you!" Asians observe many special customs at New Year's. They spend several days before the holiday cleaning the house completely, and decorating the house with flowers and plants. Flower arrangements often include pine branches, bamboo and blossoms. Blooming flowers are placed around the home. Flowers are important because flowers will turn into fruit. Fruits with special meanings are served during New Year's. Oranges and tangerines symbolize happiness. Coconuts represent togetherness, and lychee nuts represent strong family relationships. Other foods have special meanings too. A whole fish represents togetherness and bamboo shoots mean happiness to everyone. Noodles represent long life. Asians don't cut noodles, this is considered unlucky. Tofu is one food that Asians never eat during this holiday. Tofu is unlucky because it is white. In Asian cultures, the colour white signifies death.

Outside view

Part 1

Presenter This week, on *Cross-Cultural Awareness: Holidays and Customs in Asia* we meet some international students who are attending school in California. Many students here are Asian. Asians celebrate a lunar New Year, so the exact date changes every year. New Year is the biggest holiday in Asian cultures. The holiday lasts for 15 days and ends with a lantern festival on the full moon. This woman used to live in Vietnam. She now lives in California.

Vietnamese We go by the lunar calendar and so, um, our New Year's is usually in the springtime, our, the calendar here in America, so we celebrate it in

Part 2

- Presenter** Meals during New Year's are very important in Asia. But, there are special rituals and customs during mealtimes all year long. The Chinese are gracious hosts.
- Chinese** For the most part, Chinese people are very, like, um, they're very generous, like, they always insist on hosting and they would never serve themselves food before other people, like, if you're all sitting at a table they'd divvy it out, um, you'll always pour tea for other people before yourself.
- Presenter** In South Korea, mealtimes are a little different.
- Korean** South Korea has a custom of eating together, um, in, in a family setting. With, there's a base soup and all these side dishes and the whole family eats together. Um, I think in America you get your own plate, and you kind of share the, the dishes but, um, in (South) Korea you kind of dig in together.
- Presenter** We asked these Asian students if there are American customs that they don't like. In general, Asian students felt that Americans don't show enough respect for their elders.
- Vietnamese** It does bother me sometimes the way I see, um, more American kids speak to their parents, um, how they address their mums and dads in public. And, I, I really respect the fact that in Vietnam we hold it so high, um, our elders, and how the younger generation treats them.
- Chinese** I think that the respect for elders is a big thing.
- Presenter** And then, we asked Asian students what customs they like here in the United States.
- Korean** I think the custom of Thanksgiving because, um, we don't have that in (South) Korea and Thanksgiving is a good, you know, great holiday to give thanks for your family and friends and all you have.

Listening in

News report

Holi is the day to forget all your problems and be happy. Known as the "Festival of Colours" or the "Festival of Love", Holi marks the transition from the dark, cold days of winter to the brighter, warmer days of spring. It is a celebration of love, colour and the triumph of good over evil.

This Hindu religious festival continues to increase in popularity and it is celebrated by Indian communities in many parts of the world. People in South Africa, Trinidad and Tobago, the United Kingdom and Nepal are among the international groups that host large Holi events.

The festival begins in the evening with a bonfire where people gather to sing and dance. The next day, people of all ages go into the streets to have fun. They throw brightly-coloured powder and spray coloured water at each other. During Holi, Indian social codes are more relaxed. Everyone is invited to celebrate, with no distinction between rich and poor, men and women, young and old.

- 1 What do we learn about Holi from the news report?
- 2 Who is invited to celebrate Holi?

Passage 1

- Neil** What's this you're making, Jack? A dummy?
- Jack** It's called a guy.
- Sarah** Yes, we're finishing it now. We've stuffed old clothes with newspapers, haven't we, Jack?
- Jack** Yes, he looks really cool.
- Neil** What's it for? Some kind of game for Jack?
- Sarah** Kind of. It's Guy Fawkes' Night tomorrow. Actually, the proper name is Bonfire Night.
- Neil** Oh, yeah – the firework celebration! So you're making a guy and it's Guy Fawkes' Night tomorrow, Jack. What are you going to do with this guy?
- Sarah** We're going to put him on a bonfire and

burn him, aren't we, Jack? And we're going to have lots of fireworks and eat sausages and baked potatoes round the bonfire.

Jack Yes, we are. Lots of sausages.

Neil So what's the story?

Sarah Do you want to hear it?

Neil Sure!

Sarah Well, sometime right at the start of the 17th century – I think it was 1605, something like that – when James I was King of England, there was a plot to blow up Parliament.

Neil A plot to blow up Parliament. Wow! Sounds very modern!

Sarah It does, doesn't it? Anyway, this group of people tried to blow up Parliament with the King and all his family and most of the aristocracy inside.

Neil That was quite a plan.

Sarah Yes. Guy Fawkes was one of the plotters – but he wasn't the leader.

Neil He wasn't?

Sarah No, I think he was involved because he knew a lot about explosives. Anyway, these plotters hid the explosives in a cellar beneath Parliament. And Fawkes – Guy Fawkes – was caught just as he was trying to light the explosives.

Neil So if the King's men had arrived a few minutes later, Parliament would have blown up?

Sarah No, because the King's men had already found the explosives and were just waiting to catch the plotters – which they did.

Neil Ah, what happened to the plotters?

Sarah They were killed. And November 5th, which was the day they were caught, has been celebrated ever since. There's a great rhyme about it, isn't there, Jack? Remember, remember? Can you say it?

Jack Remember, remember
The fifth of November
Gunpowder, treason and plot.

I see no reason

Why gunpowder treason

Should ever be forgot.

Sarah Very good! So every November 5th people

started building bonfires and making dummies of Guy Fawkes. And now we have fireworks. Kids really love it. And everyone loves it, actually. It's a great excuse for a firework display.

Passage 2

Presenter Well, we've only got 15 hours to go to Christmas and people are frantically rushing around buying last-minute Christmas presents. But how do people really feel about these big festivals? Do we actually enjoy them? Bella, you're a psychologist, how do you feel about Christmas?

Bella I have mixed feelings about it. It's basically a religious festival but I'm not a religious person so it doesn't have that kind of meaning to me. And these days, I think for many people, it's primarily a reason for families to get together, eat a lot of good food and give each other presents.

Presenter That's a good enough reason, isn't it?

Bella Oh, absolutely, it's very important for families to have a special meal together and for people to show their love for each other. And children love it, the excitement of thinking that Father Christmas will come down the chimney and leave them presents. But at the same time, I worry about its commercialization.

Presenter Ted, you're American, a journalist, what's your attitude to Thanksgiving?

Ted I love it, and almost all Americans do, I think. It's Americans' favourite holiday – takes place on the fourth Thursday in November.

Presenter So it's a moveable feast? I didn't know that.

Ted It is. Everyone comes home and as its name suggests, it's a time to give thanks for everything we have.

Presenter What do you eat?

Ted Traditionally, we eat turkey, sweet potatoes and pumpkin. It's a huge meal – in a way, the festival is the meal.

Presenter Is it as commercialized as Christmas?

Ted Probably. But you know for many people it's a very happy occasion. And one important thing we do at Thanksgiving is we collect food for people who have very little. That's part of the tradition too.

Presenter Admirable! Douglas, as a Scot, what's the most important festival of the year for you?

Douglas Hogmanay, of course.

Presenter It's actually more important than Christmas?

Douglas Now, that's an English person speaking. I'm Scots and Hogmanay is the most important festival of the year for us. It's on December 31st. Obviously, it's New Year's Eve. But it can continue until the 2nd or 3rd of January. It's a big party really, an excuse to eat and drink I think. But it's a very old tradition. Christmas and Hogmanay are both examples of winter solstice festivals – the shortest day of the year. I'd imagine that every culture has always celebrated it in some form or other.

Presenter I think many festivals were originally connected with the seasons.

Douglas Absolutely! For example, ...